Yurii Petrunovskii

Tech & AI Communications Manager

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SUMMARY

Tech PR manager with five years of experience, including two years in-house at large technology companies. Specialises in product launches for AI, open-source, B2B SaaS and fintech products, tier-1 media relations, executive communications and owned media.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Communications Consultant, Avito Tech (contract), Remote | Sep 2026 - Present

- Produce customer case studies and product content for Trisigma, a B2B A/B testing platform.

PR Partner, Technology (PR Manager), Avito | Jun 2025 - May 2026

- Led PR for the B2B SaaS platform Trisigma and secured three CNews publications in four months, including two customer case studies based on interviews with the CPOs of Burger King Russia and Detsky Mir.
- Prepared C-level commentary and bylined articles for tier-1 media on AI, fintech and LLM inference; secured executive speaking opportunities.
- Managed the conference campaign across outdoor, partnerships and Telegram: 1,627 registrations at about RUB 1,100 each; approximately 1,000 on-site guests and 10,000 online viewers.
- Grew the AvitoTech engineering Telegram channel from approximately 10K to 15K subscribers and increased average post reach by about 30% during my tenure.
- Managed eight Telegram influencer campaigns with 104 placements, 4.4M views, RUB 2.2 per view and a total budget of about $120K.
- Delivered the EXPF Sigma acquisition and interest-free instalment announcements, with coverage in Kommersant, Habr, Forbes and Inc. Russia.

PR Manager, AI and Technology Products, Yandex | Nov 2024 - May 2025

- Led launch communications for the open-source Perforator profiler, connecting developer messaging with potential server-cost savings of up to 20%, as stated in the product announcement. The release gained 2,038 GitHub stars in five days.
- Led the developer community track of the YandexGPT 5 launch and delivered about 70% of an 11-item post-launch plan, including a podcast episode with 114K YouTube views that I organised and co-directed. Edited the Habr launch article with 130K readers.
- Co-developed the company's reactive messaging on open models after the DeepSeek release in January 2025.
- Managed the launch of the DivKit open-source UI framework update.

Strategic PR Manager, International Technology Products, Yandex | Jun 2024 - Nov 2024

- Adapted technology-product PR strategies for CIS and MENA, coordinating local agencies, media and partners, US media pitching and digital distribution.
- Developed an ESG communications project for Kazakhstan; sourced partners for a CIS research initiative with an international consultancy and sought a GR-specialist agency in MENA.

Corporate Communications Specialist, Mars | Oct 2023 - Jun 2024

- Supported communications for ESG and employee volunteering programmes.

PR Intern, PBN (PR agency) | Oct 2022 - Oct 2023

- Supported media relations for Yandex Go, Yandex Drive, Yandex Delivery and Ozon.

Social Media Manager, HSE University | Jun 2021 - Nov 2022

EDUCATION

Master's degree, International Business, HSE University | 2026

Double Bachelor's degree, Economics and Politics in Asia, HSE University and Kyung Hee University | 2019 - 2023

Exchange semester, Waseda University, Tokyo

SKILLS

Tier-1 media relations, press releases, media pitching, earned media, executive communications, thought leadership, communications strategy, product launches, AI/ML and developer communications, open source, owned media, corporate communications, crisis communications, stakeholder management, influencer marketing, agency and budget management

Tools Medialogia, TGStat, Notion, Power BI, SQL

LANGUAGES

Russian (native), English (C1), Japanese (B2)